looting of UN warehouses has been reported, and no electricity, apart from private generators.

No news about the hostage negotiations. Qatar's role is apparently crucial but very ambiguous, to say the least. For years now, the tiny Gulf state has played host to Hamas's political leadership on the one hand, as well as to US Central Command headquarters for the Middle East and Central Asia on the other. For the oil-rich monarchy, this means a permanent and precarious balancing act. It means talking out of both sides of their mouths.

As was to be expected, Netanyahu criticized the head of Military Intelligence and the head of the Shin Bet for not warning him of the dangers brewing on the eve of October 7. Soon afterward, he apologized. Despite the apology, this may be his defense tactic from now on. The Israeli public will not be swayed so easily. Anger against the PM is accumulating, including indignation at the luxurious lifestyle he's flaunting while many Israelis suffer. One of the most unbelievable aspects of Netanyahu's behavior, one that has been documented countless times, is that his criticism of his two senior commanders was apparently expressed against the opinion of a senior advisor.

As I am writing all of this, a question, in fact *the* question, is constantly on my mind: will this war convince the Israeli population that it won't be possible to reach an authentic peace settlement with the surrounding Arab states without moving toward a two-state solution? It is true that we have had peace with Egypt and Jordan and the Abraham Accords without any settlement of the Palestinian problem. But as the attitude of their populations and the declarations of their leaders make clear, in the present situation this is a brittle peace, one that may crumble at any moment. Will steps toward a settlement of the Palestinian issue ensure a more stable acceptance of Israel by the Arab world? Nobody knows. The Oslo agreements looked like a first step, but nonetheless we faced a "refusal